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## 6. Stir-fry

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Thinly sliced beef, shrimp, small chunks of chicken, and tofu cubes all cook quickly. Add to that the rapid cooking time of diagonally sliced vegetables, and stir-fry bumps nearly to the top of the list as far as time-saving dinners go.

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## 7. The power of Crock-Pot

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Obviously, the cooking time for meals in the slow-cooker drastically exceeds the 10-minute timeline. The benefit here is in the extremely reduced preparation time and flexibility. Not to mention having fewer dishes to clean afterward. It takes no time at all to toss in a pot roast along with some carrots, potatoes, and seasonings. Having a hearty dinner ready as soon as you walk through the door is decadent indeed. Many other simple, time-efficient recipes are out there for slow-cooker meal prep. A simple Internet search will yield a staggering amount of options.

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## 8. Rip and dunk

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These are simple, flexible, and depending on your choice of ingredients, extremely affordable. Hummus with a selection of flat bread and

vegetables is one way to go. Bread-bowl dinners and fondue are others. This type of dinner option can be as rustic or as elegant as you like.

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## 9. Breakfast for dinner

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This is yet another area where you have a great deal of flexibility. Using homemade baking mix for on-the-go pancakes and waffles, or serving a hearty egg scramble with sausage and peppers are both quick options.

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## 10. Affordable conveniences

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Still cheaper than take-out or restaurant dining, having a few convenience items on hand for those evenings when your schedule is completely out of whack is a viable alternative. Frozen grocery store entrées, rotisserie chicken, even fish sticks and tater tots can get the kiddies fed and in bed on time, putting you back in control of a previously out-of-control day. The time saved can be used to regroup and get things back on track for the next morning. — **Myscha Theriault**

